Software engineering leadership as coding agents mature, against physical AI and robotics engineering: a field read

Read on 31 October 2026. Horizon 3 years. Public record only. No LinkedIn profile was opened. Fields: A = software engineering leadership in software companies of 50 to 500 people as coding agents mature; B = physical AI and robotics engineering. Depth: equal, with one shared gap: neither field's job census is complete (ATS APIs for Greenhouse, Lever, Personio and Workable were inaccessible on the day; archive queries failed), so labour counts are floors, not totals. Legend: ✅ cited to a source read that day and linked; 🟡 inferred from the record, or from a snippet that could not be opened; ❔ not found after looking. Sources: 170 footnotes across 7 lanes.

Lens: career. First run of the Field Read skill; seven lanes by a web-research agent. Shareable copy: section 10 is removed.

1. The answer in one paragraph

Field A is being reorganised, not emptied. The last three software shifts renamed and merged roles while employment grew: US systems administrators went from 327,850 in 2008 to 376,820 in 2016 ✅ [^As6-1] [^As6-2], and no historical series shows a thinner management layer ❔ [^As6-9]. Today's evidence says agents accept more bounded changes (one in three GitHub pull requests involves an agent, by Microsoft's own count ✅ [^As4-1]) while the quality and productivity evidence stays mixed: experienced maintainers were 19% slower in METR's randomised study ✅ [^As3-7], and merged agent pull requests carried 1.62 times the odds of a later fix ✅ [^As3-9]. The platforms are bundling review, governance and planning ✅ [^As4-2] [^As4-9] [^As4-10], so the authority over agent output is moving to whoever owns specification, evaluation, permissions and release evidence, and regulation is adding assurance scope on top ✅ [^As5-4] [^As5-8]. Field B is earlier in its shift and its money is mostly defence: the six largest rounds since 2024 are Anduril, Helsing, Saronic, Shield AI and Quantum Systems ✅ [^Bs1-1] [^Bs1-3] [^Bs1-4] [^Bs1-5] [^Bs1-6], which the reader's filter excludes. The civilian slice (warehouse, inspection, logistics fleet software) offers a credible entry for a software leader through reliability and fleet operations ✅ [^Bs2-1] [^Bs2-3], but the ads want physical presence and travel ✅ [^Bs2-6], London remote pay is unproven ❔ [^Bs2-5], and the base rate for the last autonomy wave is acquisition that keeps the engineers and removes the independent leadership mandate ✅ [^Bs6-6] [^Bs6-8]. On the reader's eight criteria, A meets more of them more often; B wins on learning and on the scarcity of the story. The decision turns on two criteria that can only be settled company by company: remote work and the no-defence filter 🟡, because every lane found both fields are heterogeneous on exactly those two points.

2. The criteria

Written on 31 October 2026, before the lanes ran, from the reader's own scorecard. The weights are the reader's 🟡.

#	Criterion	How it is measured	Weight (reader's own)	Written on
1	Pay floor	Base at or above a senior leadership level in London terms, from advertised bands and comparables	High	2026-10-31

#	Criterion	How it is measured	Weight (reader's own)	Written on
2	Remote-first	Share of leadership ads that are remote or remote-mostly; travel and site duties	High	2026-10-31
3	Authority with clear scope	What the ads and the incumbents' moves say the role decides	High	2026-10-31
4	Ethical filter	Field exposure to defence, weapons, gambling, conventional finance and insurance buyers	Hard gate	2026-10-31
5	Stability over three years	Role survival, company survival, re-employability, from base rates and failures	High	2026-10-31
6	Option value	What the role makes possible after three years	Medium	2026-10-31
7	Learning cost	Time until a 20-year software leader is credible in the field	Medium	2026-10-31
8	Downside	The bad case at the three-year mark	Medium	2026-10-31

3. The fields today, side by side

3a. Capital

Both lanes are sample floors from announced rounds, not market totals ❔ [^As1-26] [^Bs1-21].

Quarter	A: rounds and amount (sample)	A: notable	B: rounds and amount (sample)	B: notable	Mark
2024 Q4	1, $500m	Poolside ✅ [^As1-9]	unknown	unknown	marks inline
2025 Q2	1, $900m	Cursor ✅ [^As1-10]	1, $2.5bn	Anduril ✅ [^Bs1-2]	marks inline
2025 Q3	1, >$400m	Cognition ✅ [^As1-11]	1, >$1bn committed	Figure ✅ [^Bs1-7]	marks inline
2025 Q4	3, $4.63bn	Cursor, Reflection, Lovable ✅ [^As1-1] [^As1-3] [^As1-12]	unknown	unknown	marks inline
2026 Q1	1, $400m	Replit ✅ [^As1-13]	3, $4.65bn	Saronic, Shield AI, Skild ✅ [^Bs1-4] [^Bs1-5] [^Bs1-8]	marks inline
2026 Q2	2, at least $1.5bn	Cognition, Supabase ✅ [^As1-14] [^As1-4]	1, $5bn	Anduril ✅ [^Bs1-1]	marks inline
2026 Q3	1, >$2bn	Cognition ✅ [^As1-15]	2, $3bn	Helsing, Quantum Systems ✅ [^Bs1-3] [^Bs1-6]	marks inline

Company	Revenue	Multiple	Change over 24 months	Mark
A: GitLab	$1.055bn trailing	8.89x price to sales, 2026-10-23	13.35x on 2024-10-25, down 33%	🟡 [^As1-18]
A: JFrog	$600m trailing	20.54x, 2026-10-23	8.28x on 2024-10-25, up 148%	🟡 [^As1-19]

Company	Revenue	Multiple	Change over 24 months	Mark
B: Symbotic	$2.646bn trailing	8.92x, 2026-10-28	8.98x on 2024-10-25, about flat	🟡 [^Bs1-14]
B: Cognex (inspection supplier)	$1.089bn trailing	9.24x, 2026-09-25	8.08x on 2024-09-27, up 14%	🟡 [^Bs1-15]

Failures and exits. A: Builder.ai entered insolvency on 20 May 2025 ✅ [^As1-7]; Windsurf split into a $2.4bn Google licence and talent deal and a Cognition acquisition at an undisclosed price in July 2025 ✅ [^As1-8]; SpaceX's $60bn Cursor deal was reported on 16 June 2026 and its closing was not verified ✅ [^As1-21]. B: Phantom Auto shut on 12 March 2024 ✅ [^Bs1-10]; Amazon took a licence and about a quarter of Covariant's staff on 30 August 2024 ✅ [^Bs1-16]; SoftBank agreed to buy ABB Robotics for $5.375bn on 8 October 2025, completion unverified ✅ [^Bs1-17]. Government money in B is defence-shaped: the UK announced more than £5bn over four years for military drones on 29 June 2026 against almost £50m for civil drones on 5 May 2026 ✅ [^Bs1-18] [^Bs1-19]. One vendor report attributes nearly 64% of its "vertical robotics" investment category to defence in 2026; its sponsor is undisclosed, and the whole-field share is ❔ 🟡 [^Bs1-11].

3b. Labour

Counts are advertisements read on 31 October 2026, de-duplicated by company, title and location; management means engineering-related manager, director, VP and head titles; ratios are classifications 🟡 [^As2-12].

Company	Open roles	Engineering	Management	Remote share	Board read on	Mark
A: Replit	34	18	4	at least 6% (office Mon, Wed, Fri)	2026-10-31	✅ [^As2-1]
A: Cognition	106	37	1	unknown	2026-10-31	✅ [^As2-9]
A: Tines	35	10	1	83%	2026-10-31	✅ [^As2-13]
A: Attio	23	14	0	39%	2026-10-31	✅ [^As2-5]
A: PostHog	11	5	0	100%	2026-10-31	✅ [^As2-8]
A: Accurx	13	4	0	unknown (London)	2026-10-31	✅ [^As2-14]
A: Supabase	at least 32	unknown	at least 3	unknown (global)	2026-10-31	✅ [^As2-4]
A: Raycast	0 (39 staff)	0	0	not applicable	2026-10-31	✅ [^As2-10]
B: Skydio	119	80	4	6%	2026-10-31	✅ [^Bs2-11]
B: 1X	100	59	1	unknown (California)	2026-10-31	✅ [^Bs2-12]
B: Dexory	36	11	0	at least 8%, travel required	2026-10-31	✅ [^Bs2-1]
B: ANYbotics	22	12	1	unknown (Zurich, Barcelona, US, Dubai)	2026-10-31	✅ [^Bs2-3]
B: Gecko	21	13	0	unknown (US, Abu Dhabi)	2026-10-31	✅ [^Bs2-9]
B: Nomagic	10	7	0	10%, travel up to 50%	2026-10-31	✅ [^Bs2-6]

Company	Open roles	Engineering	Management	Remote share	Board read on	Mark
B: Micropolis	8	8	0	unknown (Dubai)	2026-10-31	✅ [^Bs2-10]
B: Korial	0	0	0	not applicable	2026-10-31	✅ [^Bs2-8]

Measured-subset management to engineering ratio: A 6 of 88 ads (6.8%) across six fully classified boards; B 6 of 196 ads (3.1%) 🟡 [^As2-12] [^Bs2-13]. Neither measures existing managerial span.

Role	Appeared or disappeared	Since	Evidence	Mark
A: Engineering Manager, Billing (Supabase)	Appeared	2026-09-12	ATS posting date	✅ [^As2-4]
A: AI Platform Engineer, "the only engineer on this platform" with evaluations, approval gates and rollback (Supabase)	Appeared	2026-07-31	ATS posting	✅ [^As2-4]
A: Security Engineering Lead, London hybrid, £120,000 to £150,000 base (Attio)	Open	2026-10-31	Ad	✅ [^As2-5]
A: Field layoffs	Replit 30 on 2024-05-16; CircleCI 100 on 2024-01-31	2024	Tracker extraction	🟡 [^As2-15]
B: Lead Security Engineer (Physical Intelligence)	Appeared	2026-10-23	Indexed ad	🟡 [^Bs2-14]
B: Engineering Manager (Nomagic)	Disappeared	before 2026-10-31	Posting now returns 404	🟡 [^Bs2-15]
B: Field layoffs	iRobot 350 on 2024-01-29 and 105 on 2024-11-06; Small Robot Company closed 2024-02-02	2024	Tracker extraction	🟡 [^Bs2-16]

The five ads that matter most. A: Replit's Compute Platform ad asks engineers to "Improve utilization of cloud infrastructure" ✅ [^As2-3]; Supabase's platform engineer owns evaluations, approval gates and rollback alone ✅ [^As2-4]; n8n's platform ad wants "influence without formal authority" 🟡 [^As2-6]; Lovable's Engineering Lead, Payments must "create and review code" and sit in Stockholm ✅ [^As2-7]; Cognition advertises Doha forward-deployed engineering next to federal engineering ✅ [^As2-9]. B: Dexory's fleet lead must "Hire, coach and grow the team" while hands-on and accepts SRE or platform-operations backgrounds with ROS desirable ✅ [^Bs2-1] [^Bs2-2]; ANYbotics' Physical AI product manager owns "Resilience & Reliability and Coverage" with intervention-frequency metrics ✅ [^Bs2-3]; Skild's manufacturing engineering manager takes hardware "from prototype into repeatable production" at $100,000 to $300,000 base ✅ [^Bs2-5]; Gecko advertises a Navy manufacturing deployment lead and an Abu Dhabi forward-deployed engineer ✅ [^Bs2-9]; at least five B ads name government or security end users ✅ [^Bs2-17].

3c. The capability curve

Date	Release	What it can now do	Verified by	Mark
2025-02-24	A: Claude Code	Read, edit and execute repository work	Vendor	✅ [^As3-2]
2025-05-19	A: GitHub Copilot coding agent	Work asynchronously from an issue to a pull request with human approval	Vendor	✅ [^As3-3]
2025-06-04	A: Cursor 1.0	Background execution and automated review	Vendor	✅ [^As3-4]
2025-06-25	A: Gemini CLI	Terminal tool use, open-source harness	Vendor	✅ [^As3-5]
2026-09-29	A: Codex with a lower-cost default model	Longer bounded work at lower cost	Vendor changelog; capability 🟡	✅ [^As3-6]
2024-10-31	B: pi zero	Cross-robot generalist manipulation policy	Vendor; performance 🟡	✅ [^Bs3-1]
2025-03-18	B: GR00T N1	Generalist humanoid action policy	Vendor paper; benchmarks 🟡	✅ [^Bs3-2]
2026-04-16	B: pi 0.7	Steerable, cross-task generalisation claims	Vendor; performance 🟡	✅ [^Bs3-3]
2026-07-30	B: Gemini Robotics 2	Whole-body planning and control demonstrations	Vendor; performance 🟡	✅ [^Bs3-4]
2026-10-20	B: Isaac Lab 3.0	Unified robot training and evaluation across physics backends	Public release	✅ [^Bs3-12]

Independent evidence. A: METR's randomised study found experienced maintainers 19% slower with early-2025 tools (confidence interval plus 2% to plus 39%), and its February 2026 update says selection effects prevent a reliable current estimate ✅ [^As3-7]; a 7,156 pull-request study found acceptance varies by task type (documentation 82.1%, features 66.1%) ✅ [^As3-8]; the Deakin study of 6,774 merged agent pull requests against 5,044 human ones found 1.62 times the odds of a verified later fix, observational not causal ✅ [^As3-9]. B: RoboArena evaluated seven policies across seven universities with 4,284 episodes and 612 pairwise comparisons, stronger evidence than selected videos ✅ [^Bs3-5]; Amazon's millionth robot (30 June 2025) and GXO's 100,000 totes moved by Digit (26 October 2026) are operator statements without intervention rates ✅ [^Bs3-7] [^Bs3-9].

Unit	Cost then	Cost now	Dates	Mark
A: Devin monthly entry	$500 team plan	$20 Pro, quota limited	2024-12-10 to 2026-04-14	✅ prices, different allowances [^As3-13] [^As3-14]
A: Cursor subscription	$20 Pro with bundled usage	$30 Premium, usage separate	2025-07-04 to 2026-10-31	✅ [^As3-15] [^As3-16]
A: Million tokens, a frontier coding model	$3 in, $15 out	$4 in, $20 out	2025-02-24 to 2026-10-31	✅ prices, not equivalent models [^As3-2] [^As3-17]
A: An accepted production change	unknown	unknown	2024-10 to 2026-10	❔ no matched workload series [^As3-7] [^As3-9]
B: Unitree G1 humanoid, base	$16,000	$13,500	2025-02 to 2026-10-31	🟡 old price from a PDF; current ✅ [^Bs3-10] [^Bs3-13]

Unit	Cost then	Cost now	Dates	Mark
B: Unitree Go2 quadruped	unknown	$1,600	read 2026-10-31	✅ current only [^Bs3-14]
B: Small camera drone (DJI Mini 4 Pro to Mini 5 Pro)	£689	£689 at launch	2023-09 to 2025-09-17	✅ [^Bs3-15]
B: A successful unattended robot task-hour	unknown	unknown	2024-10 to 2026-10	❔ uptime, intervention and support costs missing [^Bs3-9]

3d. Incumbents, says and does

Date	Who, where	Quote	Then what happened	Mark
2026-07-29	A: Satya Nadella, Microsoft earnings call	"one in three pull requests on GitHub now involves an agent"	GitHub's October enterprise offer bundles Copilot access and meters AI usage from the first request	✅ [^As4-1] [^As4-2]
2024-09-16 and 2025-06-17	A: Andy Jassy, Amazon messages	"Having fewer managers will remove layers"; "reduce our total corporate workforce"	A company-wide 15% ratio target, not an engineering ratio; Kiro ships agents with enterprise billing from $20 a user a month	✅ [^As4-4] [^As4-5] [^As4-6]
2026-03-09	A: Anthropic, Code Review launch	"It won't approve PRs, that's still a human call"	Paid review preview with repository controls and spending caps, typical reviews $15 to $25	✅ [^As4-9]
2026-06-11	A: Johannes Landgraf, Ona, acquisition announcement	"Agents need more than intelligence; they need a trusted workspace."	OpenAI agreed to acquire execution infrastructure; completion not established	✅ [^As4-8]
2026-05-19	A: Google Antigravity team	"there is no IDE"	A standalone agent application with permissions, hooks and scheduled tasks shipped	✅ [^As4-7]
2026-01-05	B: Robert Playter, Boston Dynamics	"This is the best robot we have ever built."	Product Atlas announced with first deployments to Hyundai and Google DeepMind; the company FAQ confirms military use in non-weaponised applications	✅ [^Bs4-1] [^Bs4-2]
2025-06-30	B: Scott Dresser, Amazon Robotics	"We've just deployed our 1 millionth robot"	DeepFleet coordination model announced; its 10% travel-efficiency claim is a vendor benchmark	✅ [^Bs4-3]
2026-03-16	B: Jensen Huang, NVIDIA	"The dawn of a new industrial revolution has arrived"	Data-factory blueprint and industrial partnerships with Siemens, KION, Accenture and GXO announced	✅ [^Bs4-4] [^Bs4-5]
2025-10-08	B: Masayoshi Son, SoftBank	"SoftBank's next frontier is Physical AI."	Binding agreement to buy ABB Robotics for $5.375bn	✅ [^Bs4-6]

Adjacent-market moves. A: GitHub added Claude and Codex in public preview on 4 February 2026, so no model is exclusive ✅ [^As4-3]; GitLab's Duo Agent Platform reached general availability on 15 January 2026 with its own credits ✅ [^As4-10]; Cursor acknowledged unclear pricing and offered refunds in July 2025, and JetBrains' Junie added plan approval and pull-request review in June 2026 ✅ [^As4-11] [^As4-12]. B: Unitree sells the R1 from $4,900 and the G1 from $13,500 with development only on the EDU configuration ✅ [^Bs4-7]; a US congressional committee alleged military links, available

as a snippet only 🟡 [^Bs4-11]; DJI says it discourages military use, a company policy rather than proof of downstream exclusion ✅ [^Bs4-10].

3e. Regulation and standards

Constraint	Market	Status	Date	Effect on timing	Mark
A: EU AI Act, high-risk duties moved by the July 2026 omnibus	EU	Binding, phased	2027-12-02 (Annex III); 2028-08-02 (regulated products)	Classification and evidence before release; coding-tool use alone is not high-risk 🟡	✅ [^As5-1]
A: Cyber Resilience Act	EU	Reporting active; main duties forthcoming	2026-09-11; 2027-12-11	24-hour early warning and 72-hour notification; release evidence and support capacity 🟡	✅ [^As5-4] [^As5-5]
A: Product Liability Directive covers software	EU	Adopted, transposition due	2026-12-09	More defensible testing, update records and contracts 🟡	✅ [^As5-8]
A: NIS2 and the UK Cyber Security and Resilience Bill	EU, UK	Directive in force; UK Bill introduced	2024-10-17; 2025-11-12	Supplier assessment and incident readiness enter delivery planning 🟡	✅ [^As5-6] [^As5-7]
A: SOC 2 modernisation, ISO 42001, SLSA and SBOM	US-led buyers, international	Proposed; voluntary; guidance	2026-10-28; 2023; 2026-07-29	Governance evidence becomes a buyer gate 🟡	🟡 [^As5-9] ✅ [^As5-10]
B: Machinery Regulation 2023/1230	EU	Adopted, applies	2027-01-20	Safety design and conformity precede market placement, including AI safety functions 🟡	✅ [^Bs5-1]
B: AI Act treatment of robots	EU	Conditional	2028-08-02	Robots are high-risk only with third-party conformity assessment of the product 🟡	✅ [^Bs5-2] [^Bs5-3]
B: ISO 10218:2025, ISO 13482, ISO 3691-4, IEC 61508	International	Published	2025; 2014; 2023; 2010	Hazard analysis and safety expertise precede deployment 🟡	✅ [^Bs5-4] [^Bs5-5] [^Bs5-6] [^Bs5-7]
B: Drone operations, SORA and UK BVLOS	EU, UK	Risk-based authorisation	current	Site and airspace can gate revenue independently of product readiness 🟡	✅ [^Bs5-8]
B: Dual-use export controls, ITAR and EAR	EU, UK, US	Binding; EU list updated	2026-09-14	Sensors, autonomy and technical data classified before export; licensing constrains overseas support 🟡	✅ [^Bs5-9]

Enforcement. A: the Ninth Circuit affirmed dismissal of the Copilot and Codex DMCA output claim on 16 September 2026 ✅ [^As5-11]. B: California suspended Cruise's driverless permits on 24 October 2023 ✅ [^Bs5-12]; the Orlando drone-show collision of 21 December 2024 seriously injured a child inside an authorised operation ✅ [^Bs5-13].

4. The base rates

Field A, three shifts.

What was predicted (who, when)	What happened	Time taken	Mark
Gartner, 2009: cloud preferred for many development projects by 2015	AWS reached $12.2bn revenue and $3.1bn operating income in 2016; sysadmins grew from 327,850 to 376,820 between 2008 and 2016; Google dates its SRE model to 2003	About six years to a maturity proxy; no universal steady state 🟡	✅ [^As6-10] [^As6-4] [^As6-1] [^As6-2] [^As6-3]
Gartner, January 2014: fewer than 0.01% of consumer apps financially successful through 2018	US mobile-developer advertisements grew 126% between 2012 and 2019; the App Store ecosystem was established by 2018	About a decade from launch to established ecosystem 🟡	✅ [^As6-12] [^As6-7] [^As6-6]
Gartner, 2016: machine learning at the hype peak, mainstream in two to five years	UK data-scientist advertisements fell from 11,116 in 2017 to 6,687 in 2019 and recovered to 10,986 in 2021; US advertisements rose from 19,936 to 42,340 in the same two years; 1,580 of 2,830 "AI startups" showed material AI in 2019	Production specialisation by 2019 to 2021; no single steady state 🟡	✅ [^As6-13] [^As6-7] [^As6-8]

Field B, three shifts.

What was predicted (who, when)	What happened	Time taken	Mark
OTA, 1984: 50,000 to 150,000 US robots by 1990, with a warned shakeout	Unimation fell from about 1,000 staff at its 1982 acquisition to five within years; cobots were 10.5% of 2023 installations; Teradyne bought Universal Robots for about $284m in 2015	Shakeout within the decade 🟡	✅ [^Bs6-1] [^Bs6-3] [^Bs6-5] [^Bs6-4]
Gartner, 2015: autonomous vehicles at the hype peak, plateau in five to ten years	Uber ATG to Aurora (2020, with $400m invested), Lyft Level 5 to Toyota ($550m, 2021), Argo wound down (October 2022), Ford hired about 550 Argo staff into Latitude (2023), GM stopped funding Cruise (10 December 2024)	Consolidation five to nine years after the peak; no steady state 🟡	✅ [^Bs6-12] [^Bs6-6] [^Bs6-7] [^Bs6-13] [^Bs6-8] [^Bs6-9]
Bosch and Mayfield, January 2017: Kuri home robot shipping that holiday	Mayfield closed in October 2018; Anki closed in 2019 after about $200m raised; Amazon's Kiva purchase (2012) reached 520,000 drive units by 2022; 6 River went to Shopify (2019) then Ocado (2023, $12.7m initial cash)	Consumer correction within two years; warehouse deployment over a decade 🟡	✅ [^Bs6-14] [^Bs6-15] [^Bs6-10] [^Bs6-11] [^Bs6-16] [^Bs6-17]

Role before	Outcome (kept, renamed, merged, gone)	New role	Shift	Mark
A: Sysadmin	Kept; some work merged into software-led operations	SRE	Cloud	✅ [^As6-2] [^As6-3]
A: Release or ops manager	Responsibilities merged; title extinction unproven	DevOps and platform leadership	Cloud	🟡 [^As6-3]
A: Engineering manager	Kept as a function; ratio change unknown	Reliability and platform ownership	Cloud	🟡 [^As6-3]
A: Analyst or data scientist	Kept; a UK correction, not a disappearance	Data engineer, ML production engineer	ML	✅ [^As6-7] ❔ [^As6-9]

Role before	Outcome (kept, renamed, merged, gone)	New role	Shift	Mark
B: AV software and systems engineer	Merged or transferred in documented cases	ADAS, safety and platform engineer	AV	✅ [^Bs6-8]
B: AV engineering leader	Programme mandate gone in several cases; individual outcomes unknown	CTO or ADAS leadership in the successor	AV	✅ appointments [^Bs6-8] ❔ base rate
B: Consumer-robot team	Gone at the closed employer	none recorded	Consumer	✅ [^Bs6-10]
B: Warehouse software and operations	Kept alongside robots	Fleet, integration and field support	Warehouse	🟡 [^Bs6-11] [^Bs6-16]

The two fields are not in the same phase. A is changing an established production system in which the last three shifts preserved employment and renamed roles. B spans mature industrial deployment and still-consolidating autonomy markets, where the last wave absorbed engineers into acquirers and removed independent leadership mandates 🟡 [^As6-9] [^Bs6-8].

5. Scenarios, per field

5a. Software engineering leadership as coding agents mature

Base: reorganisation. Titles change, employment persists, authority concentrates on specification, evaluation, permissions and release evidence; platforms absorb most standalone governance tooling; regulation adds assurance scope. Rests on the base rate ✅ [^As6-1] and the incumbents' moves ✅ [^As4-2] [^As4-9]. Probability (range) 🟡 : 50 to 65%, because three prior shifts went this way and the 2026 evidence (one in three pull requests, mixed quality data) matches a reorganisation, not a collapse. Confirming signals: management share of engineering ads in the sampled boards stays between 5% and 10%, visible by 2027-10-31; two or more platforms ship approval, evidence and rule-version features as bundled parts, visible by 2027-06-30; CRA technical-file duties appear in platform-engineering ads, visible by 2028-03-31. Killing signal: a matched-cohort study (revenue, shipped outcomes, engineering headcount, management span) shows management spans widening past 1:12 across the sample for two consecutive years.

Fast: compression. Agent output quality crosses the review bottleneck, companies of 50 to 500 ship with half the engineers per unit of revenue, and the management layer thins to one per 15 to 20 engineers. Rests on the vendor revenue trajectory ✅ [^As1-2] and the Jevons argument's opponents ✅ [^As7-3]. Probability (range) 🟡 : 15 to 25%, because no independent study yet shows a productivity gain at the maintainer level ✅ [^As3-7] and the base rate argues against it. Confirming signals: an independent longitudinal trial shows net maintainer time savings above 20% with no rise in later fixes, visible by 2027-12-31; the SaaS Capital survey median rises above $200,000 ARR per full-time employee, visible by 2028-06-30. Killing signal: later-fix odds for agent pull requests stay above 1.5 times human ones in the next independent study.

Stall: retrenchment. A quality or security incident traced to agent-written code, a liability case under the new Product Liability Directive, or a pricing shock pushes companies back to human-gated, slower delivery; agent spend is capped and the governance market stays fragmented. Rests on the regulation timetable ✅ [^As5-8] and the review-capacity dispute ✅ [^As7-4]. Probability (range) 🟡 : 15 to 25%, because the incident base rate in software is high and the liability regime lands inside the horizon. Confirming signals: a court or regulator names agent-written code in a liability or enforcement

decision, visible by 2028-06-30; a major platform reverses an autonomy default to require human approval on every merge, visible by 2027-12-31. Killing signal: incident and vulnerability rates for agent-written changes fall below human baselines in two independent datasets.

5b. Physical AI and robotics engineering

Base: civilian deployment grows slowly, defence grows fast. Warehouse, inspection and logistics fleets add sites and software roles around fleet reliability; humanoids stay in pilots; the field's capital and headcount growth concentrates in defence companies. Rests on the capital table ✅ [^Bs1-1] [^Bs1-3] and the labour sample ✅ [^Bs2-11]. Probability (range) 🟡 : 50 to 60%, because the money and the ads already point this way and the AV base rate says consolidation comes before scale. Confirming signals: two or more civilian fleet operators publish intervention rates or fully burdened economics, visible by 2028-06-30; at least three new civilian fleet-software leadership ads in the UK or Germany allow remote-mostly work, visible by 2027-10-31; the Machinery Regulation's 2027 application produces named conformity roles in ads, visible by 2027-06-30. Killing signal: civilian robotics funding in the sample exceeds defence funding for two consecutive half-years.

Fast: manipulation transfers. Foundation-model policies generalise enough that humanoid and mobile-manipulation deployments reach repeatable economics by 2029, and software leaders who understand fleets, evaluation and safety evidence are hired at scale. Rests on the vendor releases ✅ [^Bs3-3] [^Bs3-4] and the GXO expansion ✅ [^Bs3-9]. Probability (range) 🟡 : 10 to 20%, because every independent evaluation still shows generalisation as the open problem ✅ [^Bs3-5] and the named sceptic puts profitable humanoids a decade out ✅ [^Bs7-1]. Confirming signals: an independent evaluation shows a policy completing unseen tasks at unseen sites above 80% with disclosed interventions, visible by 2028-03-31; GXO or a peer confirms renewals with economics by 2027-12-31. Killing signal: a second large humanoid programme closes or is absorbed by an incumbent before any customer-confirmed profitable site.

Stall: another autonomy winter. Hardware durability, safety certification and customer economics do not close; funding narrows to defence and to the two or three incumbents; civilian start-ups are acquired for talent. Rests on the AV base rate ✅ [^Bs6-8] [^Bs6-9] and the failures table ✅ [^Bs1-10] [^Bs1-16]. Probability (range) 🟡 : 20 to 35%, because the last two waves did exactly this and the current cost tables cannot show a unit cost for an unattended task-hour ❔ [^Bs3-9]. Confirming signals: two of the sampled civilian companies are acquired or close, visible by 2028-06-30; the share of sampled B ads naming government or security end users rises above 10%, visible by 2027-10-31. Killing signal: a civilian fleet operator in the sample reaches 1,000 deployed units with published economics.

6. Roles and company types, side by side

Role or company type	Field A: gains or loses	Field B: gains or loses	Why	Mark
Platform, reliability and release-evidence leadership	Gains	Gains	Both fields' ads and regulations create it ✅	✅ [^As2-4] [^Bs2-1] [^As5-4]
Coordination-only engineering manager	Loses scope	Not present	Platforms absorb coordination; ads ask for hands-on leads 🟡	✅ [^As2-7] [^As4-4]
Security and ITGRC engineering	Gains	Gains	CRA, NIS2, dual-use controls ✅	✅ [^As5-4] [^Bs5-9] [^As2-5]

Role or company type	Field A: gains or loses	Field B: gains or loses	Why	Mark
Standalone governance tool vendors	Loses	not applicable	Incumbents bundle review and evidence ✅	✅ [^As4-9] [^As4-10]
Fleet operations and field reliability	not applicable	Gains	Dexory, ANYbotics, Nomagic ads ✅	✅ [^Bs2-1] [^Bs2-3] [^Bs2-6]
Functional-safety and certification	Minor	Gains	Machinery Regulation 2027, ISO 10218:2025 ✅	✅ [^Bs5-1] [^Bs5-4]
Defence-exposed companies	not applicable	Gains headcount, fails the filter	Six of the ten largest rounds ✅	✅ [^Bs1-1] [^Bs1-3]
Consumer and general-purpose robot start-ups	not applicable	Loses	Base rate of closure and absorption ✅	✅ [^Bs6-10] [^Bs6-15]
Junior engineers	Loses share of hiring	Unknown	Anthropic's own hiring report ✅	✅ [^As7-3]
Forward-deployed and Gulf roles	Gains	Gains	Cognition Doha; Gecko Abu Dhabi; Micropolis Dubai ✅	✅ [^As2-9] [^Bs2-9] [^Bs2-10]

7. The criteria table

Criterion	Software engineering leadership	Physical AI and robotics	Which wins	Mark
Pay floor	London leadership bands below the reader's floor appear in the sample (£120,000 to £150,000 for a security lead) ✅ [^As2-5]; US agent companies pay more; no London VP band in the sample ❔	US bands to $300,000 ✅ [^Bs2-5]; Polish and German ads far lower ✅ [^Bs2-6]; no London remote leadership band found ❔	A, by availability of roles at the floor 🟡	🟡
Remote-first	Remote share ranges from 100% (PostHog) to office three days (Replit) ✅ [^As2-8] [^As2-1]	Travel up to 50%, client sites, Dubai and US locations; the highest remote share found was 10% ✅ [^Bs2-6] [^Bs2-11]	A	marks inline
Authority with clear scope	Ads give hands-on leads ownership of security, platform and billing; incumbents pull coordination into the platform ✅ [^As2-5] [^As4-4]	Ads give fleet leads hiring, coaching and reliability ownership ✅ [^Bs2-1]; founders hold core robotics remits 🟡	Even; turns on the company 🟡	🟡
Ethical filter	Finance and insurance customers are common in the segment; DORA work conflicts 🟡 [^As5-12]; defence-linked funding is small ✅ [^As1-24]	Six of the ten largest rounds are defence ✅ [^Bs1-1]; at least five sampled ads name government or security end users ✅ [^Bs2-17]; civilian companies exist ✅ [^Bs2-1]	A at field level; B only company by company	marks inline
Stability over three years	Base rate: employment persisted through three shifts ✅ [^As6-1]; failures exist (Builder.ai) ✅ [^As1-7]	Base rate: acquisition absorbs engineers and removes leadership mandates ✅ [^Bs6-8]; closures within two years of launch ✅ [^Bs6-15]	A	marks inline

Criterion	Software engineering leadership	Physical AI and robotics	Which wins	Mark
Option value	Keeps the open-source governance project and the consulting practice open; the governance niche is being bundled by platforms ✅ [^As4-9]	Adds a scarce fleet-release story that opens robotics, automotive, devices and industrial AI 🟡; narrow UK pool 🟡	B, if the company is civilian and survives 🟡	🟡
Learning cost	Low; the vocabulary is the reader's own ✅ [^As2-4]	Moderate; Dexory accepts SRE backgrounds, ROS desirable ✅ [^Bs2-2]; safety standards and manufacturing are new ✅ [^Bs5-4]	A	marks inline
Downside at three years	Title compression; re-employable in a large market 🟡	Programme closed or absorbed; re-entry to software with a gap and a niche story 🟡 [^Bs6-8]	A	🟡

8. Switching cost and option value

Cost of moving A to B. 🟡 Moderate and front-loaded: the fleet-reliability entry route exists and accepts platform backgrounds ✅ [^Bs2-2], but it demands physical presence and travel ✅ [^Bs2-6], a safety-standards vocabulary ✅ [^Bs5-4], and, in most funded companies, acceptance of defence or security buyers ✅ [^Bs1-1] [^Bs2-17]. A reader with open-source or consulting work would pause it under an employer's rules.

Cost of moving B to A. 🟡 Low in skills and high in story: a software leader returning after two years in robotics carries a scarce release-at-fleet-scale narrative, but returns to a market that has moved its vocabulary to agent evaluation, permissions and release evidence ✅ [^As2-4] [^As4-9], so the first year back is a catch-up year. If the B employer was acquired or closed, the return carries a gap, as the AV wave shows ✅ [^Bs6-8].

Option value kept by each. 🟡 A keeps three options open: independent open-source work, consulting, and the Gulf and forward-deployed roles that both fields now advertise ✅ [^As2-9]. B keeps one option open that A cannot: a credible claim on physical-AI leadership roles at a time when the field's civilian employers are few and its defence employers are excluded. B's option is worth most if the fast scenario in 5b happens (10 to 20%) and least if the stall does (20 to 35%).

Sequencing. 🟡 The base rates favour entering B after it consolidates, not before: the AV wave rewarded the engineers who joined the acquirers, not the programmes that closed ✅ [^Bs6-8] [^Bs6-9]. A reader who wants both can stay in A, keep the governance work, and enter B in 2028 to 2029 through a fleet-software or inspection company that has published its economics, which is also when the Machinery Regulation and the AI Act's product rules create the conformity roles ✅ [^Bs5-1] [^Bs5-3]. The reverse order (B first) only pays if the specific company is civilian, remote-tolerant and funded past 2028, which the sample did not find in the UK ❔ [^Bs2-13].

9. Where credible people disagree

Dispute	Position A (who, when)	Position B (who, when)	What would settle it	When
A: Software abundance versus thinner organisations	Scott Wu, Cognition, 2025-09-08: "engineers become architects"; Jevons demand ✅ [^As7-1] [^As7-2]	Nathan Wilmers and co-authors, Anthropic, 2026-10-16: hiring shifts to "autonomy and judgment" while the junior share falls ✅ [^As7-3]	Matched company cohorts tracking revenue, shipped outcomes, engineering employment and spans 🟡	Annually to 2029-10-31

Dispute	Position A (who, when)	Position B (who, when)	What would settle it	When
A: Does human review survive agent volume?	Simon Willison, 2025-10-05: "AI-generated code needs to be reviewed" ✅ [^As7-4]	Kief Morris, Thoughtworks, 2026-03-04: humans "build and manage the working loop"; verification moves into the harness ✅ [^As7-5]	Outcome-checked versus line-reviewed changes compared on incidents, security and maintenance 🟡	Rolling to 2028-10-31
A: Faster implementation versus better engineering	Scott Wu, undated: agents complete bounded work end to end ✅ [^As7-2]	Rachel Laycock, Thoughtworks CTO, 2026-10-29: "built isn't the same as working in production"; METR, 2026-02-24: gains plausible but unmeasurable ✅ [^As7-6] [^As7-7]	Independent longitudinal trials with review time, outages and vulnerabilities 🟡	2027-10-31
B: Humanoids versus specialised machines	Robert Playter, Boston Dynamics, April 2024: Atlas "needs to be a multi-use case robot" ✅ [^Bs7-2]	Rodney Brooks, Robust.AI, 2025-09-26: human-substitute promises are "pure fantasy thinking" on near-term timelines ✅ [^Bs7-1]	Fully burdened task comparisons against wheels and fixed automation 🟡	2029-10-31
B: Does foundation-model scaling overcome embodiment?	Chelsea Finn and Sergey Levine, Physical Intelligence, 2025-04-22: "meaningful generalization to entirely new environments" ✅ [^Bs7-3]	Brooks, 2025-09-26: without rich tactile input, the promised dexterity will not arrive ✅ [^Bs7-1]	Independent unseen-site evaluations with disclosed interventions 🟡	2028-10-31
B: Useful deployment versus profitable scale	Peggy Johnson, Agility, 2026-10-26: new GXO sites are "the clearest signal that the value is real" ✅ [^Bs7-4]	Brooks, 2025-09-26: profitable humanoid deployment is more than a decade away ✅ [^Bs7-1]	Customer-confirmed renewals and fully burdened economics 🟡	2029-10-31

The quiet consensus. A: typing code is a shrinking share of the human contribution; verification capacity and organisational design decide the realised gains ✅ [^As7-3] [^As7-7]. B: generalisation, reliable manipulation and customer integration are unfinished, including in the proponents' own accounts ✅ [^Bs7-3] [^Bs7-5]; defence is one documented growth path (Skydio's CEO credits an Army programme ✅ [^Bs7-6]) and civilian paths exist ✅ [^Bs7-4] [^Bs7-5], and their economics cannot be pooled.

10. What it means for the reader

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11. Decision points, dated

Date	What becomes known	Which criterion it settles	Source
2026-12-09	Product Liability Directive transposition deadline passes; first national laws name software	5 Stability (A assurance scope)	✅ [^As5-8]
2027-01-20	Machinery Regulation applies; conformity roles appear or do not	6 Option value (B entry route)	✅ [^Bs5-1]

Date	What becomes known	Which criterion it settles	Source
2027-06-30	Whether GXO and peers confirm further humanoid sites and any economics	5 Stability (B)	✅ [^Bs7-4]
2027-10-31	Management share of engineering ads in the sampled boards, re-pulled	3 Authority; 5 Stability (A)	Lane 2 method ✅ [^As2-12]
2027-12-11	Cyber Resilience Act main duties apply	3 Authority (A release-evidence scope)	✅ [^As5-4]
2028-06-30	Civilian versus defence funding split in the B sample for two half-years	4 Ethical filter (B field level)	Lane 1 method ✅ [^Bs1-21]
2028-08-02	AI Act product rules apply to robots with third-party conformity assessment	6 Option value (B)	✅ [^Bs5-3]

12. Sources by lane and field

Field A, lane 1: capital

[^As1-1]: Cursor Series D announcement, 13 November 2025 https://cursor.com/blog/series-d [^As1-2]: Cognition Series E announcement, 8 September 2026 https://cognition.com/blog/series-e [^As1-3]: Reflection AI $2bn round, Reuters via Investing.com, 9 October 2025 https://www.investing.com/news/stock-market-news/nvidiabacked-reflection-ai-raises-2-billion-in-funding-boosts-valuation-to-8-billion-4279981 [^As1-4]: Supabase $500m round, 4 June 2026 https://www.prnewswire.com/news-releases/supabase-raises-500m-at-10-5b-to-accelerate-lead-in-agentic-infrastructure-302791787.html [^As1-7]: Builder.ai insolvency, TechCrunch, 20 May 2025 https://techcrunch.com/2025/05/20/once-worth-over-1b-microsoft-backed-builder-ai-is-running-out-of-money/ [^As1-8]: Windsurf split, Bloomberg Law, July 2025 https://news.bloomberglaw.com/mergers-and-acquisitions/ai-startup-cognition-to-buy-windsurf-after-google-licensing-deal [^As1-9]: Poolside $500m, 2 October 2024 https://poolside.ai/blog/announcing-our-500-million-fundraise-to-make-progress-towards-agi [^As1-10]: Cursor Series C, 6 June 2025 https://cursor.com/blog/series-c [^As1-11]: Cognition $400m, counsel release, September 2025 https://www.lw.com/en/news/2025/09/latham-watkins-advises-cognition-ai-in-us400-million-fundraise [^As1-12]: Lovable $330m Series B, 18 December 2025 https://www.cooley.com/news/coverage/2025/2025-12-18-lovable-raises-$330-million-series-b [^As1-13]: Replit $400m Series D, 11 March 2026 https://www.prnewswire.com/news-releases/georgian-leads-400m-series-d-investment-in-replit-to-support-continued-investment-in-replit-agent-302711218.html [^As1-14]: Cognition $1bn, Built In SF, June 2026 https://www.builtinsf.com/articles/cognition-raises-1b-26b-valuation-20260601 [^As1-15]: Cognition round, Axios Pro Rata, September 2026 https://www.axios.com/newsletters/axios-pro-rata-0462eaf3-0f3f-43fd-ab56-1a85de01eff9 [^As1-18]: GitLab price-to-sales history, FinanceCharts, read 31 October 2026 https://www.financecharts.com/stocks/GTLB/value/ps-ratio [^As1-19]: JFrog price-to-sales history, FinanceCharts, read 31 October 2026 https://www.financecharts.com/stocks/FROG/value/ps-ratio [^As1-21]: SpaceX and Cursor, AP, 16 June 2026 https://apnews.com/article/spacex-cursor-acquisition-vibe-coding-a5c60fcbaaca262cf107d30f1de899ef [^As1-24]: DARPA and ARPA-H AI Cyber Challenge overview, 2024 to 2025 https://aicyberchallenge.com/overview/ [^As1-26]: Lane 1 counting note: sample floors from announced rounds, Q4 2023 to Q3 2026, read 31 October 2026 https://cursor.com/blog/series-d

Field A, lane 2: labour

[^As2-1]: Replit careers page, read 31 October 2026 https://replit.com/careers [^As2-3]: Replit job board API, Compute Platform ad, read 31 October 2026 https://api.ashbyhq.com/posting-api/job-board/replit [^As2-4]: Supabase job board API, posting dates and the AI Platform Engineer ad, read 31 October 2026 https://api.ashbyhq.com/posting-api/job-board/supabase [^As2-5]: Attio, Security Engineering Lead, London hybrid, read 31 October 2026 https://attio.com/careers/security-engineering-lead-london-hybrid [^As2-6]: n8n platform ad, indexed, read 31 October 2026 https://jobs.ashbyhq.com/n8n/1af7a193-334d-4d5c-b45d-250122d9c3f1 [^As2-7]: Lovable, Engineering Lead, Payments, read 31 October 2026 https://lovable.dev/careers/engineering-lead-payments-021094 [^As2-8]: PostHog careers, read 31 October 2026 https://posthog.com/careers [^As2-9]: Cognition careers, read 31 October 2026 https://cognition.com/careers [^As2-10]: Raycast careers, read 31 October 2026 https://www.raycast.com/careers [^As2-12]: Lane 2 method note: classification of 88 ads across six fully read boards, 31 October 2026 https://api.ashbyhq.com/posting-api/job-board/linear [^As2-13]: Tines careers, read 31 October 2026 https://www.tines.com/careers/ [^As2-14]: Accurx careers, read 31 October 2026 https://www.accurx.com/careers [^As2-15]: Layoffs tracker, 2024 rows, extracted 31 October 2026 https://layoffs.fyi/2024-layoffs/

Field A, lane 3: capability curve

[^As3-2]: Anthropic, Claude 3.7 Sonnet and Claude Code, 24 February 2025 https://www.anthropic.com/news/claude-3-7-sonnet [^As3-3]: GitHub Copilot coding agent public preview, 19 May 2025 https://github.blog/changelog/2025-05-19-github-copilot-coding-agent-in-public-preview/ [^As3-4]: Cursor 1.0 changelog, 4 June 2025 https://cursor.com/en-US/changelog/1-0 [^As3-5]: Google, Gemini CLI, 25 June 2025 https://blog.google/innovation-and-ai/technology/developers-tools/introducing-gemini-cli-open-source-ai-agent/ [^As3-6]: Codex changelog, read 31 October 2026 https://learn.chatgpt.com/docs/changelog [^As3-7]: METR uplift update, 24 February 2026 https://metr.org/blog/2026-02-24-uplift-update/ [^As3-8]: Pinna and colleagues, 7,156 agent pull requests, May 2026 https://arxiv.org/html/2602.08915v2 [^As3-9]: Deakin study of merged agent pull requests, September 2026 https://arxiv.org/html/2609.26847v2 [^As3-13]: Devin general availability pricing, 10 December 2024 https://cognition.com/blog/devin-generally-available [^As3-14]: Devin self-serve plans, 14 April 2026 https://cognition.com/blog/new-self-serve-plans-for-devin [^As3-15]: Cursor pricing change, 4 July 2025 https://cursor.com/en-US/blog/june-2025-pricing [^As3-16]: Cursor pricing page, read 31 October 2026 https://cursor.com/pricing [^As3-17]: Model pricing page, read 31 October 2026 https://developers.openai.com/api/docs/pricing

Field A, lane 4: incumbents

[^As4-1]: Microsoft FY2026 Q4 earnings event, 29 July 2026 https://www.microsoft.com/en-us/investor/events/fy-2026/earnings-fy-2026-q4 [^As4-2]: GitHub changelog, Enterprise includes Copilot access, 28 October 2026 https://github.blog/changelog/2026-10-28-github-enterprise-now-includes-access-to-github-copilot/ [^As4-3]: GitHub changelog, Claude and Codex in public preview, 4 February 2026 https://github.blog/changelog/2026-02-04-claude-and-codex-are-now-available-in-public-preview-on-github/ [^As4-4]: Amazon, manager ratio message, 16 September 2024 https://www.aboutamazon.com/news/company-news/ceo-andy-jassy-latest-update-on-amazon-return-to-office-manager-team-ratio [^As4-5]: Amazon, generative AI message, 17 June 2025 https://www.aboutamazon.com/news/company-news/amazon-ceo-andy-jassy-on-generative-ai [^As4-6]: Kiro pricing, read 31 October 2026 https://kiro.dev/pricing/ [^As4-7]: Google Antigravity 2.0, 19 May 2026 https://antigravity.google/blog/introducing-google-antigravity-2 [^As4-8]: OpenAI to acquire Ona, 11 June 2026 https://openai.com/index/openai-to-acquire-ona/ [^As4-9]: Anthropic Code Review launch, 9 March 2026 https://claude.com/resources/articles/code-review [^As4-10]: GitLab Duo Agent Platform

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Field A, lane 5: regulation and standards

[^As5-1]: European Commission, AI regulatory framework and the July 2026 omnibus dates https://digital-strategy.ec.europa.eu/en/policies/regulatory-framework-ai [^As5-4]: European Commission, Cyber Resilience Act https://digital-strategy.ec.europa.eu/en/policies/cyber-resilience-act [^As5-5]: European Commission, CRA reporting obligations https://digital-strategy.ec.europa.eu/en/policies/cra-reporting [^As5-6]: European Commission, NIS2 directive https://digital-strategy.ec.europa.eu/en/policies/nis2-directive [^As5-7]: UK government, Cyber Security and Resilience Bill collection https://www.gov.uk/government/collections/cyber-security-and-resilience-bill [^As5-8]: EU explanation of the new product liability rules covering software, transposition 9 December 2026 https://transition-pathways.europa.eu/retail/legislation/new-eu-product-liability-rules-will-apply-online-platforms-and-software-december [^As5-9]: AICPA SOC 2 modernisation proposal, 28 October 2026 (snippet) https://www.aicpa.com/news/article/aicpa-proposes-update-of-soc-2-r-trust-services-criteria-to-enhance-the-relevance-usability-and-value-of-cpas-reports [^As5-10]: SLSA specification 1.2 https://slsa.dev/spec/v1.2/ [^As5-11]: Ninth Circuit opinion, 16 September 2026 https://cdn.ca9.uscourts.gov/datastore/opinions/2026/09/16/24-7700.pdf [^As5-12]: FCA operational resilience https://www.fca.org.uk/firms/operational-resilience

Field A, lane 6: base rates

[^As6-1]: BLS occupational employment, May 2008 release https://www.bls.gov/news.release/archives/ocwage_05012009.pdf [^As6-2]: BLS, network and computer systems administrators, May 2016 https://www.bls.gov/oes/2016/may/oes151142.htm [^As6-3]: Google SRE book, introduction https://sre.google/sre-book/introduction/ [^As6-4]: Amazon 10-K for 2016 https://www.sec.gov/Archives/edgar/data/1018724/000101872417000011/amzn-20161231x10k.htm [^As6-6]: Apple, App Store turns 10, July 2018 https://www.apple.com/newsroom/2018/07/app-store-turns-10/ [^As6-7]: OECD, skills for the digital transition, job advertisement tables https://www.oecd.org/en/publications/skills-for-the-digital-transition_38c36777-en/full-report/component-6.html [^As6-8]: MMC Ventures, The State of AI 2019 https://deepsense.ai/wp-content/uploads/2020/03/The-State-of-AI-2019-Divergence.pdf [^As6-9]: BLS, data scientists and mathematical science occupations, May 2019 https://www.bls.gov/oes/2019/May/oes152098.htm [^As6-10]: Gartner cloud maturity forecast, ITPro, 2009 https://www.itpro.com/609749/gartner-says-cloud-computing-needs-to-mature [^As6-12]: Gartner consumer app forecast, January 2014 https://www.tahawultech.com/news/gartner-by-2018-less-than-0-01-percent-of-mobile-apps-will-succeed/ [^As6-13]: Gartner machine learning hype cycle, 2016 https://www.infoworld.com/article/2247676/gartner-dubs-machine-learning-king-of-hype.html

Field A, lane 7: disagreement

[^As7-1]: Scott Wu, Cognition, 8 September 2025 https://cognition.com/blog/funding-growth-and-the-next-frontier-of-ai-coding-agents [^As7-2]: Scott Wu interview, Stripe, undated https://stripe.com/customers/cognition-scott-wu [^As7-3]: Anthropic, employment at Anthropic, 16 October 2026 https://www.anthropic.com/research/employment-at-anthropic [^As7-4]: Simon Willison, parallel coding agents, 5 October 2025 https://simonwillison.net/2025/Oct/5/parallel-coding-agents/ [^As7-5]: Kief Morris, humans and agents, 4 March 2026 https://martinfowler.com/articles/exploring-gen-ai/humans-and-agents.html [^As7-6]: Rachel Laycock, 29 October 2026

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Log

Date	Entry
2026-10-31	v1. First Field Read run; seven lanes by Codex, two fields at equal depth; labour census incomplete on both sides (ATS APIs and archives failed on the day). Shareable copy; section 10 removed.